Katrina Ridout
NUTRITION



A FREE GUIDE FROM AN ACCREDITED PRACTISING DIETITIAN

Your 7-Day Pregnancy Meal Plan

A week of simple, Australian meals and snacks that follow current food safety advice for pregnancy. Real portions, a snack pick-list and a shopping list, so you can stop second-guessing and just eat.

Katrina Ridout, Accredited Practising Dietitian (APD008207) · Brisbane and telehealth Australia-wide

START HERE

How to use this plan

This is a guide, not a set of rules. Swap days around, repeat the meals you like, and use leftovers. Every day gives you three meals and two or three snacks, because eating regularly helps with energy, nausea and steady blood glucose.

Hungrier some days?

That is normal. Your needs change through pregnancy. Most women need little or no extra food in the first trimester, a little more in the second, and a bit more again in the third. Add a snack from the pick-list when you are hungry. You do not need to "eat for two".

Less hungry or nauseous?

Eat smaller amounts more often. Dry crackers, toast, cold foods and plain carbohydrate are often easier. Page 9 has more ideas. If you cannot keep food or fluids down, see your GP or midwife.

What a day looks like across the food groups

The Australian Dietary Guidelines suggest these serves a day for pregnant women aged 19 to 50. The plan is built around them.

VEGETABLES	5 serves (1 serve = ½ cup cooked veg or 1 cup salad)
FRUIT	2 serves (1 serve = 1 medium piece or 2 small pieces)
GRAINS	8½ serves, mostly wholegrain (1 serve = 1 slice bread, ½ cup cooked rice or pasta, ½ cup cooked oats)
PROTEIN FOODS	3½ serves (1 serve = 65 g cooked meat, 80 g cooked chicken, 100 g cooked fish, 2 eggs, 1 cup legumes, 30 g nuts)
DAIRY OR ALTERNATIVES	2½ serves (1 serve = 1 cup milk, 200 g yoghurt, 40 g hard cheese, or a calcium-fortified plant milk)

Supplements most women need

- **Folic acid** 400 micrograms a day, from at least one month before pregnancy through the first three months. Some women need a higher dose, so check with your GP.
- **Iodine** 150 micrograms a day through pregnancy and breastfeeding. If you have a thyroid condition, ask your doctor first.
- **Iron, vitamin D and others** only if your blood tests or your doctor say so.

KEEP YOU AND YOUR BABY SAFE

Food safety in pregnancy, the short version

Pregnancy changes your immune system, so infections like listeria and salmonella are more serious. Every meal in this plan already follows the advice below, based on Food Standards Australia New Zealand (FSANZ).

AVOID	Deli and sliced cold meats, pâté, pre-cut or pre-packed salads and fruit, soft and semi-soft cheeses (brie, camembert, ricotta, feta, blue) unless cooked until steaming, raw or runny eggs, raw seafood and sushi, cold smoked salmon, raw sprouts, unpasteurised milk and juice, soft-serve ice cream.
FINE TO EAT	Hard cheeses (cheddar, parmesan, tasty), pasteurised yoghurt and milk, eggs cooked until firm, canned tuna and salmon, freshly cooked meat, chicken and fish, commercial mayonnaise, fruit and vegetables you wash and cut yourself.
FISH	Aim for 2 to 3 serves a week of lower-mercury fish (salmon, barramundi, canned tuna, sardines). Limit shark (flake) and billfish (swordfish, marlin) to 1 serve a fortnight with no other fish that fortnight. Limit orange roughy and catfish to 1 serve a week with no other fish that week.
LEFTOVERS	Refrigerate within 2 hours, eat within a day, and reheat until steaming hot all the way through.
DRINKS	No alcohol is the safest choice. Keep caffeine under 200 mg a day (about 2 cups of instant coffee, or 1 café coffee). Water is your main drink.

Not sure about a food? Read Kat's article *What foods should you avoid during pregnancy in Australia?* at katridout.com.au/blogs/foods-to-avoid-during-pregnancy-australia/

DAY 1 Simple start

BREAKFAST	2 Weet-Bix with 1 cup milk, ½ sliced banana and 1 tbsp chia seeds
SNACK	1 apple and 30 g unsalted nuts (a small handful)
LUNCH	Wholemeal wrap with 80 g freshly cooked chicken (or leftover chicken reheated until steaming), 1 cup washed lettuce, grated carrot and cucumber, 1 tbsp hummus
SNACK	170 g tub Greek yoghurt with ½ cup fresh berries
DINNER	100 g baked salmon, 1 cup cooked brown rice, 1½ cups steamed broccoli, carrot and green beans (recipe: Grilled salmon with greens on katridout.com.au)

DAY 2 Warm and filling

BREAKFAST	2 eggs scrambled until firm, 2 slices wholegrain toast, ¼ avocado and sliced tomato
SNACK	4 wholegrain crackers with 40 g cheddar
LUNCH	2 cups homemade lentil and vegetable soup with 1 slice wholegrain bread
SNACK	Carrot and capsicum sticks with 3 tbsp hummus
DINNER	Beef stir-fry: 100 g lean beef strips, 2 cups mixed vegetables, 1 cup cooked noodles or rice, cooked until the beef is no longer pink

DAY 3 Batch-cook day

BREAKFAST	½ cup rolled oats cooked with 1 cup milk, ½ cup berries stirred through while cooking, 1 tbsp peanut butter
SNACK	1 pear and 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds
LUNCH	Tuna niçoise: 95 g canned tuna, 1 small boiled potato, ½ cup green beans, 1 hard-boiled egg, washed salad leaves, olive oil and lemon (recipe: Tuna niçoise salad)
SNACK	Smoothie: 1 cup milk, 1 small banana, 2 tbsp yoghurt and a handful of spinach (recipe: Green smoothie)
DINNER	Chicken and vegetable bolognese: 100 g chicken mince, grated zucchini and carrot, tomato passata, over 1 cup cooked wholemeal pasta, 1 tbsp grated parmesan. Make a double batch for Day 4.

DAY 4 Leftovers win

BREAKFAST	Breakfast burrito: 1 wholemeal wrap, 2 eggs scrambled until firm, ¼ cup black beans, salsa (recipe: Breakfast burrito)
SNACK	1 orange and 30 g almonds
LUNCH	Leftover bolognese reheated until steaming, with a side salad you washed yourself
SNACK	2 rice cakes with 1 tbsp nut butter and ½ banana
DINNER	Beef and bean chilli: 1½ cups, with ½ cup brown rice and 2 tbsp natural yoghurt

DAY 5 No-cook lunch

BREAKFAST	½ cup natural muesli, 170 g yoghurt and ½ cup canned peaches in juice
SNACK	1 slice homemade muesli slice (recipe: Healthy muesli slice)
LUNCH	Egg sandwich: 2 slices wholegrain bread, 2 hard-boiled eggs mashed with 1 tbsp commercial mayonnaise, washed lettuce
SNACK	1 cup edamame, cooked from frozen
DINNER	120 g baked barramundi, 1 medium potato, 1½ cups roast pumpkin and capsicum, washed green salad

DAY 6 Weekend brunch

BREAKFAST	Vegetable omelette: 2 eggs cooked until set, capsicum, tomato, spinach and mushroom, 1 slice wholegrain toast (recipe: Capsicum, tomato, spinach and mushroom omelette)
SNACK	2 kiwifruit and 30 g cheddar
LUNCH	Roast carrot and grain salad with ½ cup chickpeas (recipe: Roasted carrot and grain salad)
SNACK	2 bliss balls (recipe: Best ever bliss balls)
DINNER	Lamb kofta: 100 g lean lamb mince cooked through, 1 wholemeal pita, tabouli and 2 tbsp tzatziki made with pasteurised yoghurt

DAY 7 Easy Sunday

BREAKFAST	2 slices wholegrain toast, ½ can (220 g) baked beans and 1 poached egg cooked until firm
SNACK	1 cup grapes and 30 g cashews
LUNCH	Pita pizza: wholemeal pita, tomato paste, mushroom, capsicum, 50 g cooked chicken and 30 g mozzarella, baked until bubbling
SNACK	170 g yoghurt with 1 tbsp muesli
DINNER	San choy bow: 100 g pork mince cooked through with vegetables, served in lettuce cups with 1 cup steamed rice

Snack pick-list

Pick one between meals, or two if you are hungry. Each pairs fibre with protein so it keeps you going.

- 1 piece of fruit + 30 g nuts
- 4 wholegrain crackers + 40 g cheddar
- 1 slice wholegrain toast + 1 tbsp nut butter
- 1 cup edamame
- ½ cup roasted chickpeas
- 170 g yoghurt + ½ cup fruit
- Veg sticks + 3 tbsp hummus
- 2 hard-boiled eggs + cherry tomatoes
- 1 cup milk or a milk-based smoothie
- 2 rice cakes + ¼ avocado

Still hungry after a meal?

Add another snack from the list, an extra slice of wholegrain bread, a glass of milk, or more vegetables. Hunger is a signal to listen to, not to fight.

MAKE IT EASY

Shopping list for the week

Quantities are for one person. Adjust for your household.

Fruit and veg

- Bananas 3, apples 2, pears 2, oranges 2, kiwifruit 2
- Grapes, berries (fresh)
- Lettuce, spinach, salad leaves (whole, not pre-cut)
- Carrots, capsicum 3, cucumber, tomatoes, cherry tomatoes
- Broccoli, green beans, zucchini, mushrooms, pumpkin
- Potatoes 2, avocado 1, lemon 1

Pantry

- Weet-Bix, rolled oats, natural muesli
- Wholegrain bread, wholemeal wraps and pita
- Brown rice, wholemeal pasta, noodles, rice cakes, crackers
- Lentils, black beans, chickpeas, kidney beans, baked beans
- Canned tuna, canned peaches in juice, tomato passata, tomato paste
- Peanut or nut butter, chia and pumpkin seeds, unsalted nuts
- Olive oil, commercial mayonnaise, hummus

Fridge

- Milk 3 L (or calcium-fortified plant milk)
- Greek or natural yoghurt 1 kg
- Cheddar and parmesan (hard cheeses), mozzarella
- Eggs 1 dozen

Meat and fish

- Salmon fillet 100 g, barramundi 120 g
- Chicken breast 250 g, chicken mince 200 g
- Lean beef strips 100 g, beef mince 150 g
- Lamb mince 100 g, pork mince 100 g

Freezer

- Edamame, mixed vegetables

Time saver: cook double on Day 3 and Day 4. Freeze a portion for a tired night.

Nausea, reflux and aversions

- Keep plain crackers by the bed and eat a few before getting up.
- Eat small amounts every 2 to 3 hours. An empty stomach often makes nausea worse.
- Cold foods smell less. Try yoghurt, fruit, sandwiches and smoothies.
- Sip fluids between meals rather than with them.
- For reflux, keep portions smaller, eat earlier in the evening and stay upright after meals.
- If a food on this plan turns your stomach, swap it for anything from the same food group.

See your GP or midwife if you are vomiting many times a day, cannot keep fluids down, or are losing weight.



A plan that fits you

This week of meals works for most women. Yours might need to fit gestational diabetes, PMOS (PCOS), a vegetarian diet, IVF, twins or a low iron result. That is the part Kat does with you.

Book a free 15-minute call with Kat. She will listen to where you are at, explain how she can help, and suggest the best next step.

Book a free 15-minute call

Katrina Ridout, Accredited Practising Dietitian (APD008207). Brisbane and telehealth Australia-wide. Medicare rebate applicable with a GP Chronic Condition Management Plan referral. 1300 640 104 · info@katridout.com.au

This guide gives general information for healthy pregnancies. It is not medical advice and does not replace advice from your doctor, midwife or dietitian. Food safety guidance based on Food Standards Australia New Zealand; serves based on the Australian Dietary Guidelines; supplement guidance based on NHMRC advice.